

AI-SEC Hackfest 2026 : Rules & Guidelines

Venue & Check-in Guidelines

1. **Reach the venue by 9:00 AM on 19th September 2026.**
Venue: Manipal Institute of Technology (MIT), Bengaluru.
2. **Use Gate 1 only**
All participants must enter through **Gate 1**.
3. **Carry a valid Government ID** 
Keep your Government-issued ID handy. It will be required during entry/registration.
4. **Registration starts at 8:00 AM** 
We recommend arriving early to complete registration smoothly and avoid queues.
All teams must report by **9:00 AM**.
5. **Captains: keep your Luma pass ready** 
The Luma invite/pass will be reflected **only for the team captain**, so make sure it is accessible when you arrive.

Introducing the 4 Tracks

Further details on problem statements will be shared ahead of the hackathon.

Teams can choose their problem statement under **one of the following four tracks**:

01 - AI in Red Teaming & Offensive Security

Explore AI-driven approaches to identify vulnerabilities, simulate attacks, strengthen security testing, and improve offensive security capabilities.

02 - AI in Blue Teaming & Security Operations

Build solutions that leverage AI for threat detection, anomaly detection, monitoring, incident response, and improving security operations.

03 - MCP & Agentic AI

Create innovative solutions using **Model Context Protocol (MCP)**, **AI agents**, and **agentic workflows** to solve real-world Cybersecurity problems with intelligent automation.

04 - Data Privacy, GRC

Focus on **Data Privacy, Governance, Risk & Compliance**, including risk assessment, compliance automation, privacy protection, and responsible security practices.



Choosing Your Problem Statement

When selecting or defining your problem statement, make sure it:

- **Solves a real problem:** Clearly identify the security/business challenge and who it impacts.
- **Fits the chosen track:** Your solution should have a strong connection to the track you select.
- **Uses AI meaningfully:** AI should contribute to solving the problem, rather than being added just for the sake of it.
- **Is feasible to demonstrate:** Define a focused problem that your team can turn into a functional prototype within the hackathon.



How Will Your Solution Be Evaluated?

01 - Innovation & Creativity

How unique is the idea? Does it introduce a novel approach or improve significantly on existing solutions?

02 - Security Impact & Relevance

How effectively does the solution address the chosen security problem? How relevant and impactful is it in a real-world scenario?

03 - Working Model & Efficiency

Does the solution actually work? How well does the prototype demonstrate functionality, effectiveness, scalability, and efficiency?

04 - Pitch & Presentation

How clearly does the team communicate the problem, solution, architecture, impact, and future potential through the pitch deck and presentation?

Tip: Don't just build something that works - build something that solves the *right* problem, demonstrate it clearly, and explain why it matters.